

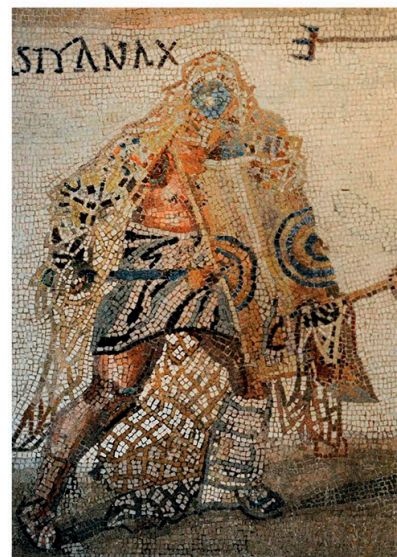


c. 100 BCE

MONTE ALBÁN GROWS

The Zapotec people continued to enlarge the city of Monte Albán in Mexico. They adorned it with stone temples, pyramids, a ball court, and a grand plaza, near which were placed hundreds of “Danzantes”, grotesque carvings probably representing prisoners. As the city grew and extended its control throughout Oaxaca, its population reached 17,000.

◀ Zapotec Danzante relief, Monte Albán



100 BCE

91 BCE The Social War breaks out, pitting Rome against its Italian allies seeking Roman citizenship

87 BCE Emperor Wu of the Chinese Han dynasty dies after five successful decades in power

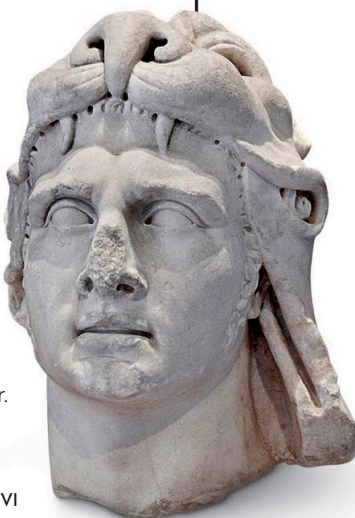


△ Coin of Indo-Scythian king Azilises, c. 40 BCE

88 BCE

MITHRIDATES ATTACKS ROMAN ASIA

When Mithridates VI, ruler of the Black Sea kingdom of Pontus, sought to expand his territory southwards, the Romans saw a threat to their province of Asia (modern western Turkey). Ignoring Roman threats, Mithridates marched into Asia and massacred 80,000 Roman citizens. In response, Rome sent an army under Sulla, beginning a bitter four-year war.



▷ Bust of Mithridates VI

c. 80 BCE

THE SAKAS CONQUER GANDHARA

In the late 2nd century BCE, the Sakas, a nomadic people of Central Asia, were forced to migrate southwards into Bactria. Under Maues, they invaded and conquered the kingdom of Gandhara around 80 BCE, establishing an Indo-Scythian state that dominated north-western India for over a century before being eclipsed by the Kushanas.